Anxious Loop-Build

Sounds like: Doechii "Anxiety"

ACCURACY C

A good approximation, not the real thing.

NOT YET TESTED - settings are a starting point; trust your ears

WHAT YOU NEED (in this order)

`NN-XT nylon-guitar patch (pluck ostinato) -> MClass EQ + Scream 4 (Tape) -> driving kit + shaker -> SubTractor sub -> stacked chant vocals`

Starting material: MIDI + rap/sung vocal; original is sample-based

---

DO THIS, STEP BY STEP

1. The ostinato: on an NN-XT nylon or muted-guitar patch, write a 2-bar syncopated single-note figure in a minor key — short notes, lots of off-beats, one note bending the minor 2nd for unease. Keep amp release short so every note plucks and dies.

2. Lo-fi the loop: MClass EQ — cut above ~8 kHz and below ~150 Hz, then Scream 4 Tape at Damage ~25. Goal: it should sound like it came off someone else's record. That "found object" quality is the aesthetic.

3. Drums: brisk and insistent. Kick on every beat in the hook sections (four-on-the-floor energy), claps layered with snare on 2+4, shaker straight 8ths. Verses: drop the four-on-floor down to a sparser kick so the hook lifts.

4. Sub: SubTractor sine following the ostinato's root notes only. Simple on purpose — the pluck loop owns the midrange.

5. Hook vocals: this production is a vocal-stack showcase. Record the chant hook 4+ times: lead center, doubles hard L/R, one harmony above. Same chain per track (Upfront Rap Vocal recipe), then bus them and compress the BUS 3–4 dB so they move as a crowd.

6. The anxiety mechanic: automation mutes. Kill the drums for the last beat of every 4th bar; drop everything but the loop for one bar before each hook. The song breathes in nervous gasps — that's arrangement, not effects.

7. Verses ride dry and conversational over the loop; energy comes from the drum arrangement, never from pushing the vocal.

Why this works

One hypnotic loop + disciplined mutes = tension that keeps renewing itself; the ear never gets to settle.

Why this order

Loop first, drums second, mutes LAST — you can't place the gasps until the full arrangement exists.

Reason trick
Put the pluck loop in a Combinator with a macro mapped to the MClass EQ high cut — automate it opening slightly into hooks for a "curtain lifting" effect without a volume change.

The skill you just learned
Loop-based song architecture: commit to one ostinato, then make arrangement subtraction do the emotional work.

Worth buying?
None needed. If you want the actual interpolation route, that's a clearance question, not a gear question.

Listen to the real song: Doechii — "Anxiety": https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=INEbUVpn8t4